

PART 13

Cheat sheet

Two pages to read on the morning: the numbers, the talking points, the say and don't-say lines, the questions to ask, and the one-page composure card. Taken from Part 13 of the Complete Interview Pack; [Sxx] markers resolve in its Part 15.

13.1 The morning page

Round 2: Tuesday 29 September 2026, 10:30 to 11:00 BST, Webex, with Joanna Chinappen (team member; organiser Jessica Cresswell, Campus Recruiter); "similar format, but more technical". The Head of the Desk is not on the invite. Round 1 passed on 7 September with Katherine Hayes and Oliver Harvey. Figures as of 17 September 2026; see the Round 2 Technical Brief of 25 September for the technical question set. C = confirmed, R = reported (press estimate), I = inferred.

WHAT MILLENNIUM IS (THREE SENTENCES)

Millennium is a private multi-manager hedge fund founded in 1989 by Izzy Englander, with assets of over \$92bn on its own site and about \$97bn per Bloomberg, roughly 6,700 to 6,900 staff and over 350 independent investment teams [S71][S70][S400]. It allocates investor capital to those teams under hard loss limits, passes its costs through to investors, and sells them a steady return that barely moves with markets: about 14% a year with one losing year since 1989 [S111][S115]. It sold a first outside stake in November 2025 and on 1 October 2026 closes \$22bn of new commitments, with Jain Global and Albar now exclusive to the platform [S82][S400][S407].

WHY THIS DESK EXISTS (TWO SENTENCES)

Hundreds of independent PM teams all want time with company management, and since 2014 in the UK and 2018 across the EU that time has been a priced, rationed, compliance-controlled service [S180][S185]. The teams compete and do not share, so one desk turns their confidential demand into one voice to the market and one fair allocation back, and proves with data which access was worth its cost.

The numbers and facts that matter

#	Fact	Source and date	Conf.
1	1989 founded by Israel "Izzy" Englander, New York, with \$35m	mlp.com; WSJ 2018 [S76][S111]	C
2	\$92bn+ / ~\$97bn AUM (site / Bloomberg 7 Sep); \$22bn closes 1 Oct, \$2bn called that day, rest over four years; five-year withdrawal restriction	mlp.com [S71]; Bloomberg via syndication [S400]	C / R
3	6,670 employees (SEC filing); site says 6,900+; 1,800+ technologists	Form ADV Aug 2026 [S70]; mlp.com [S71][S78]	C
4	350+ investment teams on the site; 265 in 2020; 160 PMs hired in one year; 32 external managers	[S71][S92][S168][S355]	C / R
5	5% / 7.5% reported PM drawdown rule: capital halved, then out. Never quote as official	Net Interest 2023; BI Oct 2024 [S104][S113]	R
6	~14% annualised since 1989; one losing year (2008, about -3%)	WSJ; BI; Englander 2009 [S111][S115][S119]	C

7	+15% / +10.5% / +8.2% returns 2024, 2025, 2026 to end-August (July -2.1%, August flat). Citadel +12.1% YTD; S&P 500 about +12% YTD per Hedgeweek	Hedgeweek [S80][S79][S402]	R
8	15% for ~\$2bn first-ever stake sale at ~\$14bn valuation, November 2025	Hedgeweek, BI [S82][S115]	C
9	1% or 20% fee floor since 2023 plus pass-through costs; investors keep "about half" of gross (analyst estimate)	Hedgeweek 2023 [S87]; Net Interest [S104]	R
10	£802m UK LLP turnover 2024, £183m operating profit, 423 employees; new LLP member from 1 Sep 2026, 75 members	Companies House [S73][S409]	C
11	Jain Global ~\$1.8bn gross profit in two years but ~8.4% net to investors; external cash returned, now \$5bn-plus from Millennium; London office kept	[S407][S228]	R
12	Anthropic partnership , August 2026: co-developing an AI risk analyst; Claude used across 340-plus teams. Say it as announced	[S386]	C
13	2 Jun 2014 FCA PS14/7: corporate access is not research; cannot be paid with dealing commission	FCA PS14/7 [S180]	C
14	3 Jan 2018 MiFID II unbundling; corporate access a "discrete service" (ESMA 2017); budgets fell 20 to 30%	[S181][S185][S191]	C
15	1 Aug 2024 FCA PS24/9 joint payments for research; corporate access "out of scope"; funds from 9 May 2025; EU from 6 Jun 2026. Nothing new since	FCA [S181][S188]; EU [S199][S200]; sweep [S415]	C
16	<£200m market cap: corporate access is an acceptable minor non-monetary benefit (COBS 2.3A.19R(5)(k))	FCA Handbook; PS21/20 [S15][S190]	C
17	82% cite one-on-one company meetings in the broker vote, the top item; Millennium's vote is semi-annual	Greenwich via Acuity [S186]; Tokyo posting [S43]	R / C
18	£7.29m Einhorn and Greenlight fine (2012) over one broker-arranged call; declining to be wall-crossed was no defence	Jones Day [S19]	C
19	10 Sep 2026 Upper Tribunal upheld the FCA ban on Crispin Odey; fine £1,529,374. Conduct enforcement is live	FCA [S413]	C
20	Round 1 intelligence: saying no to PMs is the hardest part (Katherine); organisation is half the job (Ollie); conference season is the peak; colour-coding for life; broker events often one seat per firm; origination takes years; the culture is polite	Your Round 1 debrief, 7 Sep 2026	Heard first-hand

Reading the room (first three minutes)

The thirty minutes with Joanna: expect the mechanics: the request lifecycle, allocation, the portal, the consumption report, brokers and the vote, compliance, the calendar. Answer in steps, under ninety seconds, with the record at the centre; mark what you are inferring.

If the Head of the Desk joins: the desk as a business: scale, priorities, the rule under pressure. Hold the frame on seniority.

Either: if a scenario arrives, run the protocol: steady, sort, act, close.

Logistics

Reply to Jessica Cresswell promptly and briefly; give your real availability and answer the competing-offers question honestly. Test the video link the day before. One page of notes off-camera. Say their names on hand-over. If audio drops, say so calmly. Ask about the programme length and next steps at the end of the second hour.

13.2 The lines, the questions and the room

Say this

"Millennium is built as hundreds of independent, tightly-risked teams turned into one steady return by a centre that is bigger than the investment side. That structure creates the desk: the teams can't coordinate meetings themselves, so someone has to turn their confidential demand into one voice to the market and a fair allocation back."

"A no from the desk is never just a no. It is an allocation with an alternative attached: the rule in one line, the alternative already secured, and a path to re-open it that isn't me. The consumption report is what makes the no credible, because the PM can see what the desk did get him. Trust is built in the noes."

"The desk's client base is growing faster than the desk: 350-plus teams, \$22bn closing on 1 October, external managers joining. That is a process and data problem, which is what an intern can help with."

"Flat August, eight per cent for the year against a market up more: the product is the drawdown profile, not the headline number."

Saying no to a PM: the five moves

1. **Acknowledge** the cost to the book; do not apologise for the rule.
2. **The rule, in one line.** Never who else got it, never why they ranked higher.
3. **The alternative**, already secured: group slot, IR call, next conference, a note if permitted.
4. **Escalation path:** "If you want it looked at again, I'll take it to the head of desk now."
5. **Stay in the relationship:** same tone tomorrow; log it; show the consumption report.

Don't say this

- A precise AUM, fee, pod threshold or the desk's rules as fact.
- "Best hedge fund in the world." Three rivals beat it in 2025.
- "MiFID II banned corporate access." It changed how it is paid for.
- The canteen story first. Lead with the email and AI story.
- "Talking to Anthropic about deals." Say the partnership as announced.
- Athens, Geneva or any named PM. Anything about the interviewers' private lives.
- Anything implying you plan to move to the investing side.

Questions to ask (two or three per hour)

Strategy-level (for a head of desk, or if she goes there):

1. What does the desk have to solve in the next two years to serve many more teams without losing the record or the service?
2. How is the allocation rule communicated to the team that loses, and how often is a no escalated to you?
3. How has the balance between broker-sourced and originated meetings shifted in EMEA, and where do you want it?
4. Payment optionality covers research but corporate access was ruled out of scope. Has that changed how brokers behave toward the desk?

Mechanics-level (for Joanna):

5. What does a week in conference season look like on the desk, hour by hour?
6. What in the portal or the consumption report would you change if you had an intern for ten weeks?
7. How do you keep the record when requests arrive by chat, email and in person on the same day?
8. What did the last intern do that made your job easier?

CHAPTER 13A

The composure card, on one page

The protocol, what wins when things collide, and the never list.

The cheat sheet, on one page

1. STEADY

Breathe out. Repeat the situation back.
One clarifying question if it matters.

2. SORT

Name the priority that decides it.
"What I can't do is..."

3. ACT

Two or three steps, who you tell, when.
Reversible now; escalate the irreversible.

4. CLOSE

One sentence on prevention or follow-up.
Then stop talking.

WHAT WINS WHEN THINGS COLLIDE

1. Rules and the firm's name: inside info, restricted names, how access is paid, confidentiality.
2. Fair service to every team: a rule you could explain to the loser; never tell B what A asked.
3. The process and the record: portal, log, confirmations, consumption data.
4. Speed. Real, but only inside 1 to 3.

"I'd want to be fast for the PM, but the thing that decides this is [level], so I'd [action] and tell [person] now."

NEVER, WHATEVER THE PRESSURE

Tell one team what another asked for, holds, or thinks.
Decide a contested allocation alone. Escalate it.
Skip the record because someone senior said so.
Judge for yourself whether something was inside information.
Guess a fact you don't know. "I don't know; here's my reasoning."
Badmouth a PM, a broker, a company or a past employer.

WHEN THEY PUSH

Interrupted: stop, restate the new fact, re-sort. **Contradicted:** "Which part wouldn't work?" then hold or update on merits. **Silence:** two seconds, then "want me to go deeper on any part?"

Escalated: slow down, lower pitch, "here's what I can do now and who I'm bringing in." **"Who are you to say no?":** "You're right, it isn't my call; that's why I'd take it to..."

False choice: "I'd do neither: [third path]." **Knowledge trap:** "Not public; here's how I'd reason, and I'd check the rule day one." **Badmouth bait:** decline warmly.

Twisted scenario: "That changes the timing but not the order." Changing action for a new fact is judgement; changing priorities for a frown is a broken frame.

Body: exhale before speaking; speak 10% slower than them; hands still; pen and paper off camera; correct yourself out loud if you slip.

LINES TO HAVE READY

"The desk is the firm's single point of consumption for corporate access."
"Hundreds of independent clients, one neutral desk. The neutrality is the product."
"The record isn't admin: it's the compliance evidence and the broker-vote evidence."
"Since 2014 UK managers can't pay for access with commission; it's paid separately."
"Booking windows open four to six weeks out and fill fast; the deadline is the headline."
"Group formats and multiple levels of management are how a desk stretches scarce access."
"Not my job to decide if it was inside information; my job is that compliance knows within the hour."
"I'd own it in one sentence rather than have it come out later."

Sources: [S42][S40][S43][S2][S30][S10][S20]. Say them in your words.

NUMBERS, IF THEY COME UP (say "roughly")

350+ investment teams; 6,670 staff, about 54% not investing [S71][S392].
~\$92bn; 5% a quarter withdrawals since 2018; callable commitments since 2024 [S382][S364].
One down year since 1989 (2008, about -3%) [S377]. 2025 +10.5%; 2026 to Aug +8.2% [S127][S130].
Three regional desks: Americas, EMEA, APAC; two channels: broker-sourced, originated [S43][S40].
Semi-annual broker vote; one-on-ones are the most tracked item in votes (82%) [S43][S39].
PS14/7: 2 June 2014. MiFID II: 3 January 2018. Greenlight fine 2012: over £7m [S2][S13][S19].
Interview: Monday 7 Sep, 10:00-10:30 BST, Webex, two interviewers, Round 1.

Don't volunteer numbers. Have them for when asked.

IF YOU ONLY REMEMBER ONE THING

They are not testing whether you know the answer. They are testing whether your thinking stays in order when they push. Same four steps, same priority order, same tempo, every scenario. Say what you don't know. Escalate what isn't yours to decide. Never leak across teams. Own mistakes in one sentence. Then stop talking.

Your question at the end (pick one): how the desk handles ten teams wanting the same one-on-one; whether external managers such as Jain Global are served on the same footing as internal teams; what a good consumption report actually decides.

Everything on this page is a scaffold. The interviewers will hear whether it is yours. Rehearse out loud twice, then put it away.

Figure 73. The cheat sheet. Print it; read it once on Monday morning.